

2. Eliminates faulty scripts with customised built-in alerts.
3. Monitors multiple vendor infrastructure through one Web interface.
4. Accesses applications on the private, public as well as hybrid cloud.
5. Modifies built-in templates for extensive customisation.

Android devices for server monitoring

The basic definition of a network is that it is a connection of machines. When several specifically operated machines are grouped together, they form a network. It is quite an easy job to look after, manage and control the ongoing activities of a network when you are in the office. But, the same routine task literally becomes difficult while you are away from the office or travelling out of town. Rather than depending upon a third party, you have the option of carrying out this task via your cell phone. The server acts as a medium of establishing communication between the client and Android phones.

According to a research paper by Angel Gonzalez Villan and Josep Jorba from the Open University of Catalonia, Barcelona, Spain, an Android application has been developed to run a group of server programs on a mobile device, connected to the network or USB interface. The accessibility of the server is handed over to a small client written in Java, which is operational on desktop and Web systems.

Accepting connections from different clients, the server layer performs the services of device management. The client layer – the remotely accessible one – handles the interactions between the monitored device and control equipment. This architecture system provides a host of connections to different clients, allowing remote control to all users. The implementation of server monitoring is done as an Android application for the user to activate the services provided by the service layer.

Applications used for server monitoring

Without server monitoring tools or software, IT professionals have to take on a big burden as it requires immense manual effort to manage servers and other integral applications. Remote server management looks after and upgrades the uptime of servers, failing to do which could result in a change in administrative plans. A good server audit not only gives enumerative information of the servers, but also ensures better functionality and smooth performance. This includes alerting capabilities, comprehensive coverage, performance benchmarking, data visualisation, etc.

Here is a list of a few server monitoring tools that can effectively cater to needs of businesses.

Nagios

This is one of the best monitoring tools, and empowers organisations to recognise and solve IT infrastructure issues, avoiding crucial business mishaps. This app enables users to create reports on trends, alerts/notifications and availability, all via a Web interface.

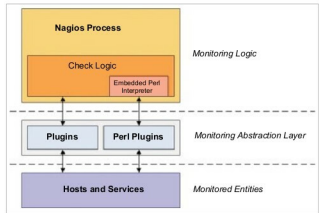


Figure 1: The Nagios process

Given below are the pros and cons of Nagios.

Pros

- Nagios is open source software. It's free to use and edit.
- It has an open configuration, which makes it easy to add custom scripts to extend the services available.
- There are many devices which the Nagios system can monitor. The requirement is an SNMP protocol on that device.
- Alerts, notifications or comments about the status of the system are provided. It has a variety of tools for this purpose.
- It has many plugins and add-ons, which are free to download and develop.

Cons

- Many features are not available on the free version of Nagios. Features such as wizards or the interactive dashboard are available on Nagios XI, which is very expensive.
- There're many configuration files which are very hard to configure.
- Nagios Core has a confusing interface.
- Nagios can't monitor all aspects of networks (such as bandwidth usage or availability).
- Nagios can't manage the network, but just monitors it.

OpenNMS

Equipped with automated and manual discovery options, OpenNMS' performance measurement has a system and measurement tool. Being open source and hence freely available, there is absolutely no upgrade or maintenance cost.

Given below are the pros and cons of OpenNMS.

Pros

- Free licensing!
- Good support and documentation through wikis and mailing lists.